

Advertising

„Advertising is a form of communication intended to persuade an audience to buy a product, ideas or services.“

It includes the name of the product/service and how it could benefit the consumer, to persuade a target market to buy or to consume that brand. These messages are mostly paid by sponsors. Commercial advertisers often try to generate increased consumption of their products through branding.

The largest advertising conglomerates (international):

- WPP
 - British multinational advertising and public relations company
 - largest advertising company (162 000 people; 110 countries)
 - clients: Ford, Shell, Vodafone, Bayer, Danone, ...
- Interpublic
 - American multinational advertising and public relations company
 - largest costumer: General Motors, Johnson & Johnson, Microsoft, ...
- Omnicom
 - American global advertising and marketing communications service company
 - 5 000 clients in more than 100 countries
 - Apple, Adidas, McDonalds, Philips, Samsonite, ...
- Publicis
 - French multinational advertising and public relations company
 - clients: BAWAG P.S.K., Renault, Schäringer, ...

Types of Advertising

→ wall paintings, billboards, street furniture, printed flyers, radio, cinema and television, web banners, mobile telephone screens, shopping carts, web popups, skywriting, bus stop benches, human billboards, magazines, newspaper, town criers, sides of buses, banners attached to or on sides of airplanes, in-flight advertisements on seatback tray tables or overhead storage bins, taxicab doors, musical stage shows, underground platforms and trains, elastic bands on nappies, stickers on apples in supermarkets, shopping cart handles, posters, back of event tickets or supermarket receipts

→ Any place an identified sponsor pays to deliver their message through a medium is advertising.

Things to consider:

- What is the target group? How many people should be targeted?
- When, where and how often should they be targeted?
- How much will it cost to reach them? Is there a budget for an advertising programme using the medium?
- Does the medium support the brand image?
- Are the potential customers likely to interact with the medium?
- What medium(s) do successful competitors use?

Online Advertising

It is a form of promotion that uses the internet to attract customers. It is delivered 24 hours a day seven days a week and consumers can get information and make purchases any time. Advertising campaigns can be updated, changed, ... immediately. It offers a precise way of targeting consumer groups according to age, gender, hobbies, ...

Television Advertising

It is considered the most effective mass-market advertising format. Television seems to be the medium where people are most likely to learn about products and brands. This is reflected in the high prices TV networks charge for commercial airtime during popular TV events. An advantage is the possibility of combining sight, sound and motion. Additionally, television advertising can target audiences easily (example: children can be reached during cartoon programmes). The production costs are extremely high.

Radio Advertising

Airtime is purchased from a station or network in exchange for airing the commercials. The production depends on the talent of the performers, effective sound effects and music that grabs listeners' attention. The ads can be run almost any time and the production costs aren't that high.

Press Advertising

It describes advertising in a printed medium such as newspaper or magazine with a very broad readership base. The benefit is the physical presence. Adverts in newspapers can be quickly changed. One of the features that most distinguishes magazine advertising from other kinds of media is the ability to define specific audiences. Topics can be fashion, family, health, gardening or weddings. They are full of ads which are designed to attract the attention of a particular target group. Magazines are noted for their long lives and their high reader involvement.

Product Placement

Product Placement is when a product or brand is embedded in entertainment and media.

Advertising process (AIDA)

- 1) An advertisement should attract the customers' attention
- 2) It should convince them that they really want the product and that it will satisfy their needs
- 3) The customers should take action by buying the product

Styles and Techniques Used in Advertising

- Using
 - beautiful/happy/sexy/famous/ordinary people; experts; babies & toddlers; animals & pets; animated objects; beautiful landscapes; music/jingles; slogans; coined words like brunch (breakfast+lunch); neologism like blog (web+log); puns; metaphors; alliterations; bright colours; different fonts and sizes
- Presenting
 - certain life-styles; shocking pictures
- Addressing people's feelings

- Working with people's dreams

Manipulative Advertising

- only focus on the positive aspects of the product
- focus on children with free toys, ...
- tell consumers that a product is convenient or handy, great or amazing
- always present products better than they are
- often use attractive people or celebrities
- make us feel insecure about our bodies
- create needs for products which aren't necessary
- create a sense of urgency with limited time offers
- use music and certain colours to evoke emotions
- are placed on social media

Analyzing and ad

- What can you see in the ad?
- Which product or service is advertised?
- Who is the advert meant for?
- Which styles and techniques are used?
- Did the advertisers follow the AIDA (Attention - Interest - Desire - Action) model? Reasons!
- Is there anything you would like to change or improve?